

Other features include -

- ▶ On-screen audio meters which is a great indicator for positioning your microphone.
- ▶ Manual gain control with negligible pestering by the AGC(Automatic Gain Control)
- ▶ Setting up crop marks according to your preference, be it 16:9 or 4:3 or a custom crop mark
- ▶ Zebra stripes (video peaking) which gives you a live histogram stating which areas of the frame are over or underexposed.



Because its an open framework, extensions can be developed for the existing versions of the software to add more features.

Will it wreck your camera?

It does not write to the ROM, so it's fairly safe. But Magic Lantern comes with no warranty or guarantee that it would work. No bricking has been reported yet, but there are chances of damage when you fiddle with the hardware. The software goes through beta testing before it reaches you, and by that time it has been used by thousands of users. So, the chances of it wrecking your camera are pretty low. Most of the risk is borne by the developers who experiment with their DSLRs while probing the camera's firmware to extract more and more features. If you want to remove it, all you need to do is format your memory card and reboot into the stock Canon firmware.

Why should you need these enhancements?

CHDK for your Canon point-and-shoot, and Magic Lantern for your Canon DSLR. These are custom firmwares which might void your camera's warranty, but give you additional features. So if you're on a tight budget but still want professional capabilities from your camera, make sure you're ready to get out of the comfort zone that the warranty gives you.

For cameras other than Canon

If you own a Canon point-and-shoot or DSLR, then you're being served on a silver platter. For all of you who own a Nikon, Panasonic or Sony good news